

1. List 5 common issues users face with USB keyboards or mice on laptops, and write one possible solution for each.

Here are 5 common issues users face with USB keyboards or mice on laptops, along with one practical solution for each:

- 1. Device not being detected**

- **Solution:** Try plugging the device into a different USB port, preferably a direct port on the laptop instead of a USB hub.

- 2. Intermittent disconnection or lag**

- **Solution:** Replace or test the USB cable/receiver and ensure the port is not loose or physically damaged.

- 3. Driver issues or outdated drivers**

- **Solution:** Update or reinstall the USB or HID drivers through Device Manager or system updates.

- 4. Keyboard or mouse not responding at all**

- **Solution:** Restart the laptop and reconnect the device after reboot to reset driver recognition.

- 5. Wireless USB mouse/keyboard not working due to low battery (for dongle-based devices)**

- **Solution:** Replace or recharge the batteries and ensure the USB receiver is properly seated in the port.

2. Simulate a troubleshooting flow: Your Bluetooth headphones are not connecting to your phone. Write the exact step-by-step actions you would take to diagnose and fix the issue, mentioning any settings or indicators you would check.

Here, the exact step-by-step troubleshooting flow I would follow if Bluetooth headphones won't connect to a phone.

- a. Confirm the basics (power + range)**

- Check if the headphones are turned on.
- Make sure they have sufficient battery.
- Bring headphones within 1 meter of the phone to avoid range issues.

b. Check phone Bluetooth status

- Open Settings/ Bluetooth.
- Look for the headphones in:
 “My Devices” / “Previously Connected Devices”
 “Available Devices”

c. Remove and re-pair

- In Bluetooth settings, find your headphones.
- Tap: “Forget This Device” / “Unpair”
- Turn Bluetooth OFF then wait 10 seconds and turn it ON again.
- Put headphones into pairing mode.
- Usually hold power or Bluetooth button for 5–10 seconds until LED flashes.
- Re-scan and select the device from the list.

d. Check the pairing mode correctly

- Confirm the LED is actually in pairing mode, not just powered on.
- If it only shows a solid light, it may already be connected to another device.

e. Check for interference or multiple connections

- Turn off Bluetooth on nearby devices the headphones may auto-connect to laptop, tablet or old phone.
- Some headphones support only one active connection at a time.

f. Restart both devices

- Restart phone (power off then wait 10 seconds and then power on).
- Restart headphones.

g. Reset the headphones

- Perform a factory reset:
- Common method: hold power + volume up/down for 10–15 seconds.
- Or follow brand-specific reset pattern.
- Watch for LED confirmation.

3. A user reports that their external webcam is not detected during a Zoom call on Windows 10. Write a checklist of 6 things to check or try to resolve the problem.

Here is a 6-steps checklist for troubleshoot of external webcam:

1) Check physical connection

- Make sure the webcam is properly plugged in. Try a different USB port and confirm the cable is not loose or damaged.

2) Verify windows recognizes the camera

- Open Device Manager → Cameras / Imaging devices and see if the webcam appears without a warning icon. If it's missing or flagged, try unplugging/replugging or restarting the PC.

3) Check Camera privacy settings

- Go to Settings → Privacy → Camera and ensure:
- "Camera access for this device" is ON".
- "Allow apps to access your camera" is ON.
- Zoom is allowed access.

4) Select the correct camera in Zoom

- In Zoom, go to Settings/ Video and manually select the external webcam from the camera dropdown.

5) Close Conflicting applications

- Other apps like Teams, Skype, browser tabs, and camera software may be using the webcam. Fully close them and relaunch Zoom.

6) Update or reinstall drivers

- In Device Manager, update the webcam driver. If that doesn't work, uninstall the device and restart the system so Windows reinstalls it automatically. Also ensure Zoom is updated to the latest version.

4. You are helping a friend whose printer is showing 'offline' status on their PC. Describe how you would use the Windows Troubleshooter tool to try to fix the issue, and explain what information the tool provides during the process.

- If a printer shows “Offline” on a Windows PC, I’d use the built-in Windows Printer Troubleshooter because it automatically checks common causes and tries to fix them.
- First, I’d open the tool. On Windows 10 or 11, I can go to Settings/Bluetooth & devices/ Printers & scanners, select the problematic printer, and then click “Run the troubleshooter” or sometimes “Troubleshoot”. Alternatively, I can open Settings/ System/Troubleshoot/Other troubleshooters/Printer/ Run.
- Once launched, the troubleshooter starts diagnosing the issue step by step. It typically checks things like:
 - Whether the printer is properly connected (USB or network/Wi-Fi)
 - If the printer is set as the default printer.
 - Whether the printer is paused or set to “Use Printer Offline”.
 - Printer Spooler service status
 - Driver issues or outdated/corrupt printer drivers
 - Network connectivity
- During the process, the tool provides real-time status messages, such as “Detecting problems,” “Checking Print Spooler service,” or “Looking for driver issues.” If it finds a problem, it usually shows:
 - A short description of the issue for example : “Printer is offline” or “Spooler service not running”
 - What Windows tried to do to fix it
 - Whether the issue was fixed automatically or needs manual action.
 - Sometimes step-by-step instructions if it can’t resolve the problem itself.
- At the end, it gives a summary report showing what was tested, what errors were found, and what changes were made. If it doesn’t fix the issue, that report is useful for manually troubleshooting further.